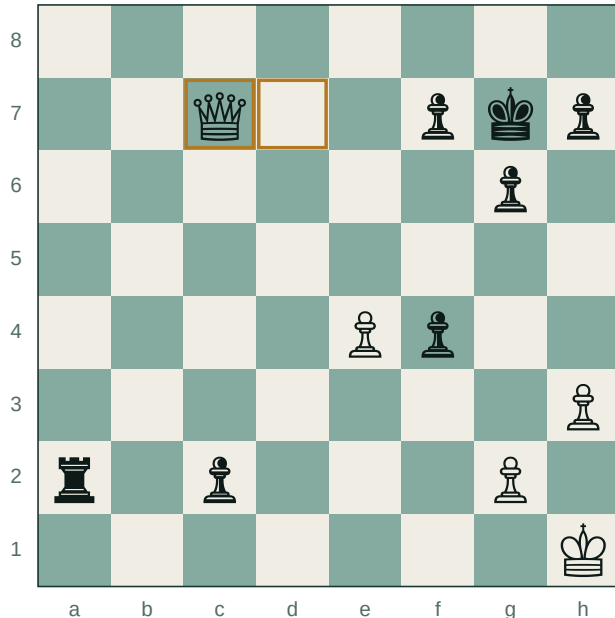


# Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 40

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 40.Qc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**40...Ra1+ 41. Kh2 c1=Q 42. Qxc1 Rxc1**

**40...Ra1+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **41.Kh2**.

**41...c1=Q** The pawn moves from c2 to c1. The pawn becomes a queen. Recorded reply: **42.Qxc1**.

**42...Rxc1** The rook captures the queen on c1.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -2 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: queen on c7. Check for tactical protection.